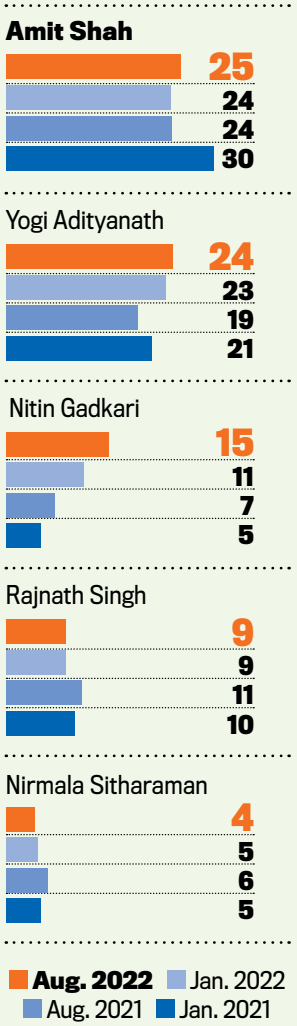


Q. Who is best suited to succeed Modi as the BJP's prime ministerial candidate?

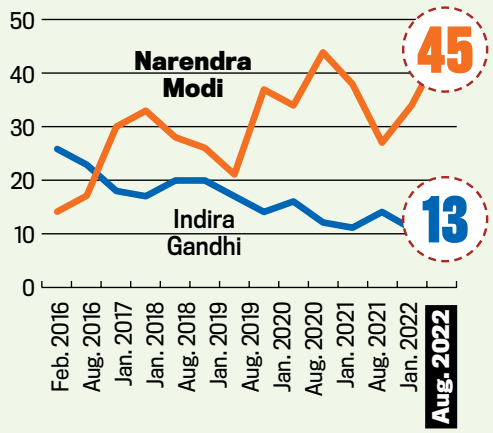


Note: Rest DK/ CS (Don't know/ can't say) and Others; all figures in percentage

Narendra Modi vs. Indira Gandhi



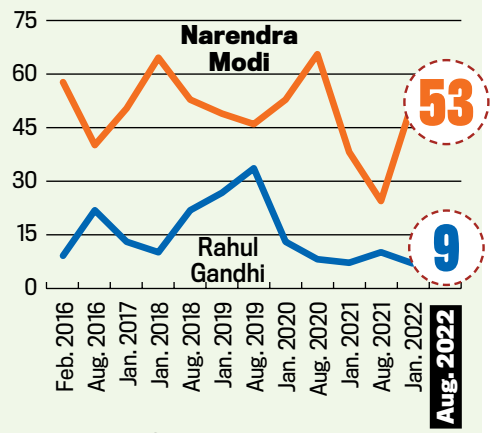
How the MOTN surveys have reflected the popularity trends for two Indian prime ministers known for their radical moves



Narendra Modi vs. Rahul Gandhi



How the MOTN surveys have reflected the mood of the public on the choice of prime ministerial candidate between the leaders of the two national parties



All figures in percentage

55%

OF THOSE WHO VOTED NON-BJP PARTIES ARE SATISFIED **WITH MODI'S PERFORMANCE AS PM**

Modi's soaring popularity then is both a phenomenon and a paradox. What explains this puzzling duality? Past developments offer little clue. In the ninth year of the UPA government, Manmohan Singh faced falling economic growth rates as well as corruption charges. The MOTN survey conducted in 2013 predicted a wipeout for UPA-II in 2014. Even Indira Gandhi, despite being re-elected as prime minister in 1971 with a massive majority, faltered in her ninth year. High inflation caused by global oil shocks and growing unemployment resulted in widespread political unrest that led her to declare an emergency in June 1975. Modi seems to defy that trend, his popularity staying buoyant despite the serious economic decline that had set in even before the pandemic hit.

Experts have deduced certain reasons for this. Pollsters generally take four key issues that determine political popularity—inflation, unemployment, corruption and national insecurity—and are regarded as electoral fundamentals. While joblessness and inflation go against the Modi government, the other two factors work in his favour. No major corruption scams or scandals have rocked the NDA government unlike the last years of the Manmohan Singh government. The MOTN survey reflects that perception, with corruption-free governance and demonetisation figuring in the top five achievements of the Modi government. When it came to handling the pandemic, although the government came up drastically short on many counts during the second wave, it more than made up for it with its massive vaccination programme, which has come in for praise even from world leaders. Together, these factors have considerably bolstered public confidence in the Modi government. Also helping deflect blame